Board 1
North Deals
None Vul

♠ K Q 6 3
♥ A K
♦ K Q 9
♣ A K Q 5

♠ 9 8 4
♥ Q J 9 7 6 4
♦ J 10 2
♣ 8

♠ 2
♥ 10 5 3 2
♦ 8 7 6 5 4
♣ J 10 3

♠ A J 10 7 5
♥ 8
♦ A 3
♣ 9 7 6 4 2

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
	2♣	Pass	2♠
Pass	4NT[1]	Pass	5♥[2]
Pass	7NT		
All Pass			

1. Blackwood
2. 2 aces

7NT by North
Lead: ♦7

You dealt this hand.

With 26 points you open 2♣. Partner responds 2♠.

Partner has 8+ points and a good 5-card ♠ suit. You are absolutely sure you will go to slam, and right now the only thing you want to know is how many Aces are in partner's hand. So you use Blackwood 4NT. Partner answers 5♥. What is your bid?

Obviously you could bid 7♠. But in fact you can count that there will be thirteen top tricks without a ruff; 5 ♠s, 2 ♥s, 3 ♦s and 3 ♣s. So you might as well bid 7NT.(By the way, the people who bid 7♠ got the opening ♣ lead ruffed!)

Board 2
East Deals
N-S Vul

♠ J 10 9 2
♥ 8 4 3
♦ K J 3 2
♣ 10 6

♠ 6 3
♥ K Q J 10 2
♦ 10 9 6
♣ 9 8 4

♠ A K Q 7 5
♥ A 6
♦ A Q 7
♣ K Q 3

♠ 8 4
♥ 9 7 5
♦ 8 5 4
♣ A J 7 5 2

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
		2♣	Pass
2♦	Pass	2♠	Pass
3♥	Pass	3NT	
All Pass			

3NT by East
Lead: ♥7

With one more point you could have made a positive response. Instead, you bid 2♦. Partner now bids 2♠. What is your bid?

Not being in love with partner's ♠s, you have enough strength to now bid 3♥. Partner replies 3NT.

When you have nothing more to say, you pass.